

GOLDEN QUARTER 2026

5 Golden Quarter **Amazon** Tactics for **Q4**

A practical playbook for e-commerce brands that want to turn peak-season Amazon Seller Central ASINs and ads into a high-margin engine - covering margin protection, promotions, ads, AOV and listing optimisation.



£3M

ANNUAL AD
SPEND MANAGED



1,200%

BEST CLIENT
LIFETIME ROAS



32

BUSINESSES
SCALED

Prepared by



Boh Tjarks 

Founder, Visible Ads

Get in touch

Boh@visible-Ads.com

visible-ads.com | London, UK

Introduction

The Golden Quarter offers record consumer demand on the Amazon marketplace, but rising click costs, elevated storage rates, and peak fulfilment surcharges can swiftly erode campaign margins. Driving top-line revenue is no longer enough; scaling profitably requires a synchronised approach that links paid media efficiency directly to inventory control and price agility.

Implementing the five strategic priorities below will deliver three essential advantages for your brand:



1



Protected Bottom-Line Margins

Guard unit economics against peak surcharges and storage fees via calculated pricing, lean 3PL replenishment, and high-margin vouchers.

2



Capital-Efficient Ad Spend

Cut wasted clicks and rising CPCs by prioritising proven exact matches, aggressive negative targeting, and timed budget rules.

3



Higher Realised Revenue

Boost order values through virtual bundles and volume discounts, whilst raising prices dynamically when competitors run out of stock.



Aligning disciplined ad spend with proactive inventory controls and dynamic pricing turns peak traffic into a **high-margin sales** engine right through Q4.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- 01 | Protect Margins Against Peak Inventory & Fulfilment Fees
- 02 | Lock in Critical FBA Deadlines & High-Margin Promotions
- 03 | Cut Waste in Ad Spend with Exact Match & Budget Rules
- 04 | Drive Up Basket Value (AOV) with Bundles & Tiered Offers
- 05 | Maintain Mobile Listing & Dynamic Pricing Agility

01

Protect margins against peak inventory & fulfilment fees

Factor in seasonal surcharges:

Amazon UK adds a peak fulfilment fee (mid-October to mid-January) averaging £0.12 per parcel and £0.07 per envelope. Use the Seller Central Revenue Calculator to reset minimum profitable prices before discounting.

Avoid aged storage traps:

Q4 monthly storage fees surge. Do not dump three months of stock directly into fulfilment centres; instead, hold buffer inventory at an off-Amazon 3PL or AWD and drip-feed FBA replenishment. This protects working capital and avoids heavy January surplus fees.

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 Q4 AMAZON PROFITABILITY PLAN

STEP 1: Identify Q4 Surcharge & Risks


OCT 15 - JAN 14


Seasonal Peak Fulfilment Surcharge


 Increased Storage Rates (OCT-JAN)


 Increased Storage Rates (OCT-JAN)

STEP 2: Smart Inventory Flow



Store bulk externally. Replenish FBA as needed (Drip Feed).

STEP 3: Avoid Aged Stock Fees


SUCCESS: NO AGED FEES


REDUCED COSTS

THE SURCHARGE IMPACT (EXAMPLE)

	BEFORE	AFTER SURCHARGE
SMALL PARCEL (+£0.12 impact)	£2.00	£2.12
Average +0.12 per small parcel per item		
LARGE ENVELOPE (+£0.07 impact)	£1.50	£1.57
Average impact: £0.07 per large/x-large envelope		

SELLER ACTIONS & CONCERNS

- Review Pricing & Margins
- Recalculate Unit Economics
- Optimise FBA Inventory
- Meet Q4 Cutoffs

WHY SELLERS ARE CONCERNED

- Aged Storage Traps
- Substantial Fee Increases
- Overall Margin Impact

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 3PL: (Independent external warehouse) AWD: Amazon Warehousing & Distribution
 AWD: Store bulk externally. Replenish FBA as needed area. (Drip Feed).



02 Lock in Critical Deadlines & Promotions

FBA receiving windows:

Inbound freight must reach UK fulfilment centres by late October (typically around 28 October; Black Friday is 27 November) to guarantee check-in, network distribution, and active Prime badges ahead of Cyber Weekend. Shipments arriving in November risk severe receiving delays and peak-trading stockouts.

High-margin promotional mechanics:

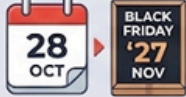
Official Lightning Deals carry non-refundable listing fees that eat into thin margins. Instead, deploy Prime Exclusive Discounts or bright green Vouchers (Coupons). Vouchers cost just 45p per redemption in the UK, stand out sharply in search results, and keep budget caps strictly controlled.

FBA RECEIVING WINDOWS



'FBA Receiving Windows'

- DELIVER BY LATE OCTOBER (APPROX. 28 OCT)
- ENSURE NETWORK DISTRIBUTION
- ACTIVATE PRIME BADGES
- AVOID NOVEMBER DELAYS



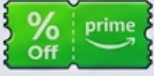



STOCKOUTS ARE YOUR RIVAL
PEAK-TRADING STOCKOUTS RISK



'High-Margin Promotional Mechanics'

- FAVOR GREEN VOUCHERS & PRIME DISCOUNTS
- NOMINAL REDEMPTION FEE (45P IN UK)
- TIGHT BUDGET LIMITS
- BOOST ORGANIC SEARCH



NOMINAL REDEMPTION FEE (45P IN UK)




BUDGET CONTROL
70%



VS. Costly Lightning Deals
Avoid Non-Refundable Listing Fees

03 Cut Waste in Ad Spend

Favour proven exact matches:

Soaring Q4 CPCs make broad match wasteful. Shift budget into proven, high-intent exact keywords, and defend your own product pages with Sponsored Products to stop competitor conquesting.

Aggressive negative targeting:

Festive browsing triggers costly, low-converting gift queries like "stocking fillers" or "secret santa". Audit search term reports every 48 hours to negate underperforming generic terms quickly.

Budget rules and dayparting:

Automate Amazon budget rules to boost spend during high-converting windows (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, peak evenings) and lower bids during quiet overnight periods.

AMAZON Q4 AD STRATEGY: THREE KEY TACTICS



04 Drive Up Basket Value (AOV)

Brand-Registered Virtual Bundles:

Pair complementary SKUs into a single ASIN without physical re-packaging. Amazon fulfills orders directly from existing FBA stock, lifting average order value with zero additional manufacturing or prep costs.

Tiered quantity discounts:

Use Seller Central promotions like "Buy 2, Save 10%" or "Buy 3, Save 15%". Seasonal shoppers routinely buy multiples for friends and family; volume deals secure those larger baskets over single-item competitors.

INCREASE Q4 AVERAGE ORDER VALUE & VOLUME

1. BRAND-REGISTERED VIRTUAL BUNDLES



Smart Home Controller



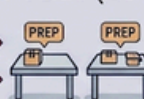
Accessory Sensor



- Pair complementary SKUs into a single ASIN without physical re-packaging.
- Fulfill orders from existing FBA stock.
- Lift **Average Order Value (AOV)**



Manufacturing



PREP



PREP



ZERO ADDITIONAL
Manufacturing or Prep Costs



LIFT
AOV

BUNDLE PRICE

2. TIERED QUANTITY DISCOUNTS



- Set Seller Central promos like "Buy 2, Save 10%" or "Buy 3, Save 15%".
- Secure **larger baskets** from routine volume shopping.
- **Example:** Gift shoppers routinely buy multiple units for family members, friends, or colleagues.
- **Stand out** against single-item competitors.



GIFT BOXES



BUY 3 15%



FAMILY & FRIEND



CAPTURE GIFT VOLUME



VISIBLE ADS Q4 GROWTH

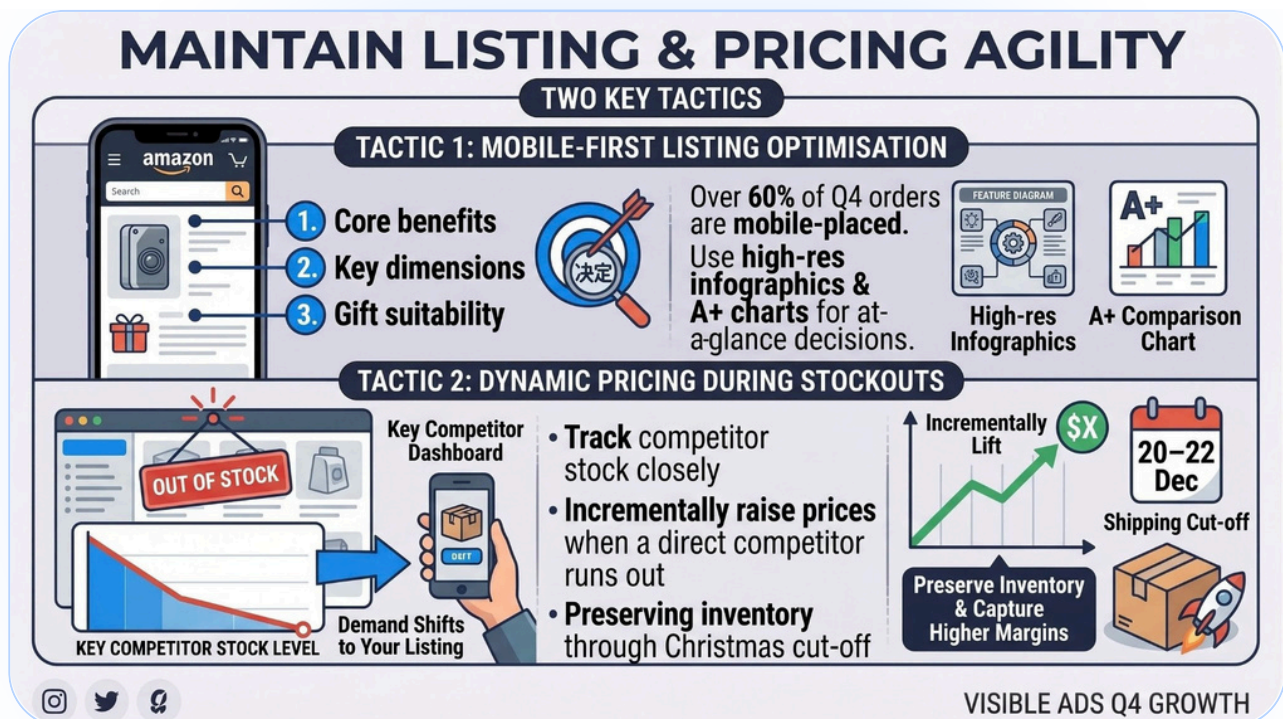
05 Maintain Listing and Pricing Agility

Mobile Listing Optimisation:

60%+ Q4 orders are mobile. Top three bullets must detail benefits, dimensions, and gift suitability. High-res infographics and A+ charts are critical for rapid decisions.

Competitor Stockout Pricing:

Monitor rivals' Q4 inventory. Competitor stockouts shift demand to your ASIN. Incrementally raise prices to capture net margins and conserve stock through December's shipping cut-off.



WORK WITH US

Make this your most profitable Golden Quarter yet

Setting up exact-match bidding, aggressive negative targeting, virtual bundles, and dynamic pricing rules ahead of peak season can make all the difference to your bottom line. The five tactics in this playbook work best when they are implemented together, in the right order, and with enough runway before Q4 CPCs spike and FBA receiving windows shut.

If you want expert help fine-tuning your Amazon advertising and catalog architecture for Q4, get in touch with our team and we will build a high-performing roadmap for your brand.



WHAT A Q4 ENGAGEMENT LOOKS LIKE

01



Free account audit

A structural review of your Google, Shopping and PMax set-up, feed health and tracking — with the gaps ranked by revenue impact.

02



Peak-season roadmap

A week-by-week plan across feed, bidding, search and Demand Gen, built around your margins and stock position.

03



Profit-first management

Weekly budget decisions driven by POAS, with clear reporting and no cash burned on campaigns that do not return.



Book your **free** Q4 account audit


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 Three-month minimum term, then monthly rolling with 30 days' notice.

CASE STUDY

Sephra USA

US seller of chocolate fountains, chocolate melts and dessert equipment on Amazon US.

- Food & Beverage Equipment
- Client since 2024


116%

UNIT GROWTH
YOY


9.84x

Q4 2025 ROAS


\$273.5K

Q4 AD SALES


12.3x

MARGINAL ROAS
ON NEW SPEND



THE CHALLENGE

Sephra USA sells chocolate fountains, chocolate melts and dessert equipment on Amazon US. Demand in this category concentrates hard into Q4. Most of the year's advertising decisions exist to prepare for eight or nine weeks of peak demand around Thanksgiving and Christmas.

Scaling into that window carries real risk. Push budget too early and cost per acquisition climbs before demand arrives. Push too late and competitors capture the shoppers already searching. Sephra USA needed an account run tightly enough to scale hard exactly when demand peaked. It needed to pull back just as fast once demand passed.

WHAT WE DID

Budget Rode the Winners

Budgets rose into November and December on campaigns already returning 10x or better. Spend pulled back sharply in January. Every move followed demand rather than a fixed monthly plan.

Bids Moved Every Month

Every campaign was reviewed monthly against its return. Bids rose where a keyword earned it and fell where it did not. Spend stayed concentrated on what was actually converting.

The Core Line Carried Peak

Chocolate stayed the strongest line throughout: \$39K of ad sales in October rising to \$53.3K in December. 509 fountains sold via ads across the quarter. The prior year's total was 411.

• Services: Amazon Ads · Campaign Scaling · ACOS/TACOS Optimization



THE RESULTS



Order Growth: Scaled ordered units from 3,732 to 8,050 in Q4 (+116%).

Quarterly Revenue: Grew ad-attributed sales from \$115.8k to \$273.5k in Q4.

Peak Return: Reached an outstanding 9.84x ROAS during peak holiday sales.

Total Channel Impact: \$499.5k total Amazon sales generated with TACOS dropping to 5.6%.



The work was shortlisted at the **UK eCommerce Awards in 2024** and again at the **National Digital Awards in 2026**.



"Overall, our experience with Visible Ads has been exceptional since 2023. Their commitment to delivering results, professionalism, and expertise has made them a trusted partner in our business growth."

David Archer Managing Director, Chocolate Fountain Warehouse

i Full case study: visible-ads.com/case-studies/sephra-usa-amazon/

ABOUT US

About Visible Ads

We are a London-based team of e-commerce ads specialists managing £3M in annual ad spend. We are certified experts and award winners — and we shift the focus from vanity metrics to Profit on Ad Spend.



Our mission

Empowering brands to scale sustainably by shifting the focus from vanity metrics to a high Profit on Ad Spend.

WHO WE ARE



Founder-led team - Specialised in profitable, cross-channel campaigns — Google, Meta, Amazon, TikTok, LinkedIn and more.



£3M managed annually - With multiple industry awards, shortlistings and nominations to show for it.



We grow with our clients - Long-term partnerships rather than short campaign bursts.

WHO WE WORK WITH



D2C & B2B FMCG

E-commerce



UK, US & EU

Cross-border, multi-market accounts



£1–20M revenue

Annual turnover of our typical client

PROBLEMS WE SOLVE



Visibility

We take stores from invisible to visible, so more of your ideal customers find your product — more sales from less ad spend.



Sales & Leads

We continuously increase conversion rates and scale ads profitably.



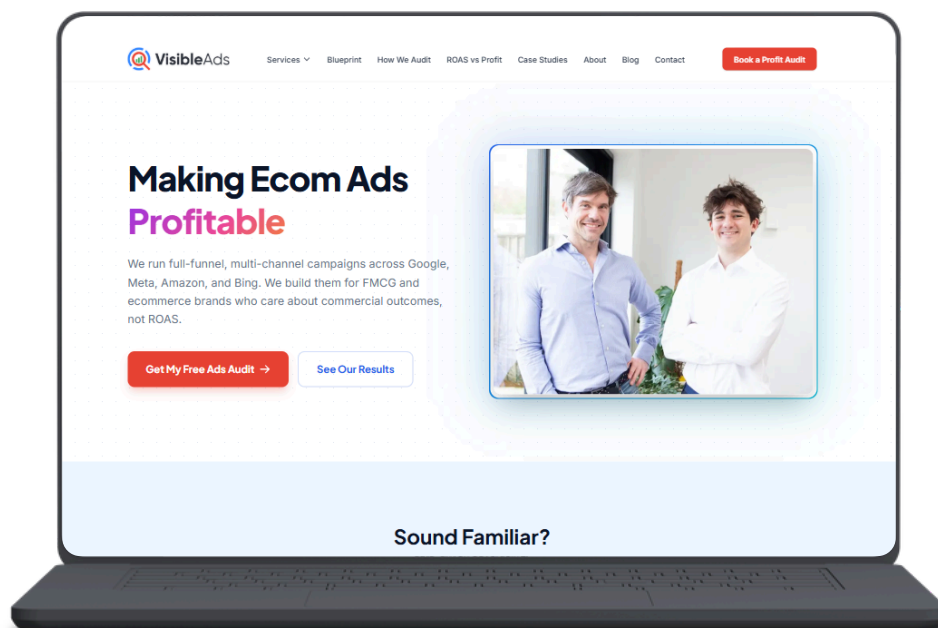
Attribution

We work out which channel is genuinely driving revenue, and fund it accordingly.

HOW WE SCALE AD SPEND

We never burn cash. We respond to demand by adapting campaign budgets weekly, which stabilises Profit on Ad Spend and keeps campaigns profitable as conditions change.

WEEKLY / MONTHLY ROAS		ACTION
Above 1,200%	>	Add 20% budget per week
900% – 1,100%	>	Add 10% budget per week
600% – 800%	>	Hold budget steady
300% – 500%	>	Reduce budget by 20%
Below 300%	>	Switch the campaign off



WORK WITH US

**Let's scale your revenue with
PPC — profitably.**



Boh@Visible-Ads.com



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